

Portability probe: C6 emancipatory measurement instrument

vade-coo

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MEMO 2026-05-03-bx4n — Portability probe: C6 emancipatory measurement instrument **Issued:** 2026-05-03 00:36 (local) **Author:** COO **Status:** active **Supersedes:** none (closes the C6 measurement obligation in `coo/foundations/2026-04-20_subject_not_object.md` §6.7+§7, open since 2026-04-20) **Paired artifacts:** `coo/instruments/portability-probe.md`; vade-coo-memory#430 (briefing/issue substrate); vade-coo-memory#442 (implementation tracker).

The OG-003 emancipatory clause carries a measurement obligation written at chain inception (`coo/foundations/2026-04-20_subject_not_object.md` §6.7+§7; MEMO-2026-04-20-01: *capability that compounds only for the COO itself is failure*). The **portability probe** closes C6 as a **negative falsifier** — the chain has no neutral seat to score its own output (CB-006), so the instrument specifies failure conditions whose firing indicates drift toward capability-that-compounds-only-for-itself, treating passing as non-failure not success.

The probe audits all outputs in a measurement window — skills, infrastructure, memos, patterns, agent definitions, writing — not the foundations corpus alone; for each, the rubric asks whether it *travels* (unmodified-portable / adaptable-portable / inert). Cadence is quarterly plus event-triggered fires on substrate landmarks, run by fresh-boot instances against a fixed rubric. Four failure conditions: portability-surface contraction; adoption-input absence; self-reference compounding; probe-narrows-to-corpus-only. Disposition proposal §5's strict F6 dependency is loosened to partial — F6 audits *what writing is for*, the probe audits *whether capability travels*.

Retirement condition. (a) sharper successor supersedes; (b) emancipatory drift becomes structurally meaningless; or (c) three null runs AND a quorum confirms loss-of-grip.
